Unit 9 India and the World



Learning Objectives

- To know about the role of India in the contemporary world.
- To grasp the policies of India towards super powers.
- To ponder over the futuristic ideals of the modern world.
- To understand about nuclear policies and it's peaceful purpose.
- To explore about globalization and it's impact in India and third world.
- To understand environmental changes and sustainable development and India's role.

9.1 Evolution of India's foreign policy (1947-54)

Independence and Partition

In the pre-independence era India's foreign policy was the responsibility of the British Raj. India contributed to the British victory in the second world war by providing necessary man power and materials. With the end of the Second World War in 1945 and the subsequent independence of India in August 1947 from the British Raj, India had to deal with the outside world by herself and have to build her own foreign policy. The post-war global political events and India's own political climate shaped India's foreign policy.

The world was polarised into two military blocs and each bloc tried to overcome the other which was known as the Cold War. Though a major war was averted, each bloc was spending enormous money in military buildups due to which tense condition prevailed. The newly liberated countries were not in a position to squander their resources in conflicts between two military blocs. They had to divert all their reources for nation building. An ideological battle known as the Cold War happened between the two superpowers of that time – the United States of America and the Soviet Union. These were also extraordinary global circumstances with the emergence of newer nations from the clutches of colonisation with new boundaries. There was large scale human migration taking place across continents while the war-tired Western powers were working on framing a new world order. The world also witnessed the formation of the United Nations Organisation on October 24 1945, through the Atlantic Charter.

Jawaharlal Nehru was the architec of India's foreign policy. India's ideological alignment, its role in the U.N and its commitment to a peaceful world were at stake. Nehru's foreign policy took in to consideration, independent India's priorities such as nation's socio-economic development, modernization, global peace, avoidance of war, peaceful and

12th_Political Science_Unit_9.indd 188 07/12/2022 13:06:43